CHICAGO ORTHOPEDIC SURGERY CENTER

321 Surgery Lane, Chicago, IL 60602
Phone: (555) 111-2233 | NPI: 9876543210

ORTHOPEDIC SURGERY PROGRESS NOTE

SUBMITTED FOR PRIOR AUTHORIZATION REQUEST

Patient: Miguel Antonio Rodriguez
DOB: November 22, 1978 (Age: 45)
MRN: MRN789012
Date of Evaluation: January 16, 2024
Insurance: Anthem Blue Cross Blue Shield (ID: ANT987654321)
Surgeon: Dr. David Michael Thompson, MD
NPI: 1122334455

SERVICES REQUESTED FOR PRIOR AUTHORIZATION

Prior Authorization Request ID: PA-SURG-2024-002
Payor: Anthem Blue Cross Blue Shield
Provider: Chicago Orthopedic Surgery Center (NPI: 9876543210)
Priority: Urgent

CPT Code	Service Description	Quantity	Unit Price	Total Cost	Service Date
29881	Arthroscopy, knee, surgical; with meniscectomy (medial OR lateral, including any meniscal shaving) including debridement/shaving of articular cartilage (chondroplasty), same or separate compartment(s), when performed	1 procedure	$8,500.00	$8,500.00	01/25/2024

Place of Service: Ambulatory Surgical Center (Code 24)

CHIEF COMPLAINT

Right knee pain and locking for 6 months, worsening despite conservative treatment.

HISTORY OF PRESENT ILLNESS

Mr. Rodriguez sustained a right knee injury 6 months ago while playing soccer. Initial injury included swelling and pain. Over the past 6 months, he has experienced persistent pain, mechanical symptoms (locking, catching), and functional limitations affecting his ability to work and participate in recreational activities.

CONSERVATIVE TREATMENT ATTEMPTED

1. **Rest and activity modification** - 3 months
2. **NSAIDs (ibuprofen 600mg TID)** - 4 months
3. **Physical therapy** - 8 weeks (16 sessions) with focus on strengthening and range of motion
4. **Intra-articular cortisone injection** - 2 months ago, provided temporary relief
5. **Knee bracing** - 3 months with functional brace

PHYSICAL EXAMINATION

Vital Signs: BP 142/88, HR 78, Temp 98.4°F
General: Alert, in no acute distress
Right Knee: Mild effusion, tenderness at medial joint line, positive McMurray test, positive Appley grind test, limited flexion (120 degrees, normal 135 degrees)
Stability: Ligamentous examination stable

DIAGNOSTIC IMAGING

MRI Right Knee (December 15, 2023):
• Complex medial meniscus tear
• Grade 2 chondromalacia medial femoral condyle
• Moderate joint effusion
• Intact cruciate and collateral ligaments

X-ray Right Knee (January 10, 2024):
• Mild joint space narrowing medial compartment
• No fracture or dislocation
• Normal bone alignment

CLINICAL ASSESSMENT AND DIAGNOSIS

Primary Diagnosis:
• M23.201 - Derangement of unspecified meniscus due to old tear or injury, right knee

Clinical Impression:
Mr. Rodriguez has a complex medial meniscus tear with persistent mechanical symptoms

despite 6 months of comprehensive conservative treatment. He is an appropriate candidate for arthroscopic meniscectomy.

INDICATIONS FOR ARTHROSCOPIC MENISCECTOMY

1. **MRI confirmed complex medial meniscus tear** - Non-repairable tear pattern
2. **Persistent mechanical symptoms** - Locking and catching episodes
3. **Failed conservative treatment for 6 months** - Including PT, injections, bracing
4. **Functional limitations affecting daily activities** - Unable to return to sports
5. **Positive clinical tests** - McMurray and Appley grind tests
6. **Ongoing pain and effusion** - Despite optimal medical management

PROPOSED SURGICAL PLAN

Procedure: Right knee arthroscopy with partial medial meniscectomy and chondroplasty
Approach: Standard arthroscopic portals (anteromedial and anterolateral)
Anesthesia: General anesthesia with regional block
Expected Duration: 45-60 minutes
Scheduled Date: January 25, 2024

MEDICAL NECESSITY JUSTIFICATION

Arthroscopic meniscectomy is medically necessary due to failed conservative treatment, persistent mechanical symptoms, and functional limitations. The procedure is indicated per AAOS guidelines for complex meniscus tears with mechanical symptoms that have not responded to non-operative treatment.

Orthopedic Surgeon:

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Dr. David Michael Thompson, MD
Board Certified Orthopedic Surgeon
License #: MD12345IL
NPI: 1122334455
Date: January 16, 2024